



Onward and upward

Atsushi Yamamoto is a Japanese Paralympian who wears a carbon-fiber running blade for the long jump and sprint events. At the 2016 Paralympics in Rio de Janeiro, he won the silver medal in the long jump competition.

ELASTICITY

A running blade functions like a spring. When an athlete takes a stride, they apply a force to the blade that causes it to bend, storing a type of energy called elastic potential energy (see page 42). The elastic blade unbends as it returns to its original shape, exerting force and releasing the stored energy. This energy changes to kinetic energy that pushes the athlete forward.

